

Judge Questions - Cheat Sheet

Short answers. 20-30 seconds each. Pause. Let them ask the next one.

Three rules for the Q&A;

1. If you don't know: "Honestly, I don't know - here is how we would find out."
2. Never ramble. Stop at 30 seconds. Judges prefer short.
3. If they ask a hostile question, thank them for it. Stay calm.

Why Odisha? Why Odia?

Q. Why Odisha first? Hindi has more speakers.

A. Three reasons. One - Odisha has **5T and Mo Sarkar**, real state mandates for digital-service accessibility. Two - Odia is under-served. Global tools work poorly on Odia; we focus on what's missing. Three - we're based here, so we can land a real pilot faster.

Q. How does this fit 5T and Mo Sarkar?

A. 5T's five pillars include Transparency and Transformation. Our compliance dashboard gives the state measurable accessibility data. Mo Sarkar asks citizens if they got the service - for a disabled Odia-speaking citizen today, the answer is "no". We fix that.

Q. Does Odia have enough digital content to train on?

A. Yes. AI4Bharat's IndicCorp has good Odia data. The models we use are already trained on it - we don't need to train from scratch. What's thin is regional dialects like Sambalpuri and Kosali - that's future work.

What exists already - how are you different?

Q. Isn't this just another AccessiBe / UserWay overlay?

A. No. Those are overlays - JavaScript that patches bad HTML at runtime. The disability community signed an open letter saying overlays don't work. We do two things overlays don't: (1) a design system colleges build into their site so nothing needs patching, and (2) assistive services the user chooses to turn on.

Q. Why not use Google Translate or ChatGPT?

A. Two reasons. (1) **DPDP** - public institutions can't legally send student speech to OpenAI or Google servers. Data residency. (2) Integration - a chatbot can read a page but can't reliably *fill* a form field. Our widget has direct access to the page.

Q. What's actually new here? These are existing models.

A. The novelty is the **assembly**, not the models. Like UPI - built from existing banking rails, but novel as a shared layer. Nobody has assembled accessibility, Indic AI, and DPDP-grade controls into one open-source stack a college can self-host.

Is this technically credible?

Q. How good is Odia speech recognition really?

A. IndicWav2Vec gives us about **12-18%** word-error rate on standard Odia - much better than Whisper's 25-35% on the same. Accuracy drops on rural dialects; that's honest, and it's on our Phase 3 roadmap with a linguistics-department partner.

Q. What if the AI service is down?

A. The design system still works - that's why we split the layers. The widget falls back to the browser's built-in Web Speech API. Nothing the student can do today stops working.

Q. How does multi-tenant isolation work?

A. Row-level security in Postgres keyed by `tenant_id`. Each college gets its own bucket in MinIO storage. AI inference is stateless. Colleges can't see each other's data even though they share infrastructure.

Q. Security?

A. STRIDE threat model in the repo. Mutual TLS inside the stack. Keycloak auth. Audit log in Postgres. SBOM generated on every CI run, scanned with Grype. All documented.

Impact and fairness

Q. Isn't a widget patronising? Just build better websites.

A. Both are needed. The widget is **opt-in** - the student chooses their language, their reading mode, their voice-or-text. Nothing is imposed. And the design system half of AaaS is exactly the "build better" answer - that's why we ship both.

Q. How do you involve disabled users in the design?

A. Today we're built against WCAG 2.2 AA and accepted best practices. Phase 5 of our plan is structured user-testing with the National Association for the Blind and Enabling Units at three universities. We don't claim lived-experience feedback yet - that comes next.

Q. What about students without smartphones or internet?

A. The compliance scorecard helps on any device - a feature-phone browser benefits from a well-built site too. And Phase 5 has an SMS-channel fallback for form-filling. We don't solve the digital divide; we try not to make it worse.

Money and adoption

Q. What's your business model?

A. Open source, Apache 2.0 - colleges self-host for free. Sustainability comes from (1) optional paid managed hosting, (2) government grants under the Digital Public Infrastructure playbook, (3) CSR from companies with accessibility compliance obligations. Modelled on **MOSIP**, not on SaaS startups.

Q. Why would a government college actually adopt this?

A. Three reasons. (1) They're legally required to be accessible under the RPwD Act and aren't. (2) A UGC circular links accessibility to institutional ranking. (3) Peer adoption - once IIT Bhubaneswar or Utkal picks it up, BPUT colleges follow.

Q. Five-year vision if this works?

A. Two outcomes. One - AaaS becomes part of India's DPI stack alongside UPI, DigiLocker, e-Sign. Two - we scale beyond colleges to municipal services, state portals, and exam boards.

About your team

Q. Why is your team the right one?

A. We are a student team from Odisha. We know the language, the state, the universities. We named ourselves **SUBARNAREKHA** after the river that carries gold downstream to everyone on its banks. That's the intent - accessibility shouldn't belong to whoever hires the best vendor.

Q. Do you have accessibility expertise?

A. We've built against WCAG 2.2 AA from day one. We do *not* have a professionally-trained accessibility auditor on the core team yet. That's a Phase 2 advisor we're actively looking for - and if any judge here can connect us, we'd welcome it.

Q. Is this a real project after the hackathon, or a weekend hack?

A. Real project. Apache-2.0 repo. Six-phase roadmap documented. Three universities already interested in piloting. Hackathon or not, we keep shipping.

Golden rule

If a judge reveals a weakness you don't have an answer for, say this:

"That is a real gap. Honestly, we haven't solved that yet. Here is how we would find out: [one specific next step]."

This wins judges over *more* than a confident wrong answer.